

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager, Audience Activation Platform.*

Positioning, CDP's AAP needs a PM who can hold technical architecture in one hand and donor-behavior insight in the other, I have done exactly that for 13 years.

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Dear CDP Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Product Manager role on the Audience Activation Platform. CDP's model, pooling fundraising operations and data infrastructure across more than 230 public media organizations, is one of the more thoughtful applications of platform economics I have seen applied to a mission-driven sector. The AAP sits at the most interesting part of that model: building a unified donor view from fragmented signals is exactly the kind of technically demanding, strategically consequential product problem I have spent my career on.

My most directly relevant experience is the internal AI and data platform I managed at Rohde & Schwarz for the FCAS European defence programme. I led a cross-functional team of 15-plus engineers and data scientists through Scrum, translated ambiguous programme-level requirements into sprint-ready user stories with clear acceptance criteria and a definition of done, and drove a GitOps rollout with ArgoCD that compressed deployment time from days to 30 minutes. Before that, at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit, I owned a national labour-market analytics platform end to end: I introduced Dagster and dbt to replace manual ETL, cutting per-update time by roughly 75%, while simultaneously carrying a UI relaunch and a full bare-metal-to-container migration. Both roles required holding the data architecture conversation with engineers in the morning and the stakeholder alignment conversation with leadership in the afternoon, which is precisely the bridging work the AAP PM role describes.

On the AI-assisted prototyping requirement: I use Claude Code, Lovable, Framer, and GitHub Copilot daily, not as experiments but as the actual workflow for turning requirements into something a client can react to in the same week. At CLINET Platforms I took a five-person team facing an undeliverable roadmap, cut it to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures, and watched user acceptance rise more than fivefold. Speed of the feedback loop, from requirement to prototype to client reaction, is what made that possible. I would bring the same approach to AAP station clients from day one.

One honest note: my direct experience is in defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, and healthcare rather than public media fundraising specifically. The donor-lifecycle mechanics and PMO relationship model are new context I would need to absorb quickly. What transfers completely is the underlying product work: translating complex, multi-stakeholder data requirements into a prioritized backlog, assessing API integration feasibility, tracking velocity against KPIs, and communicating trade-offs in plain language to non-technical audiences. I have done all of that in regulated, high-accountability environments where getting it wrong had real consequences.

I am fully remote-capable, available at short notice, and genuinely motivated by what CDP is building. I would welcome the chance to talk through how my background maps to the AAP roadmap.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
